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ETCHING METHOD AND PLASMA PROCESSING APPARATUS

Abstract

To provide a technique of preventing shape abnormalities due to etching of a silicon film. An etching method includes: (a) providing, on a substrate support disposed in a chamber, a substrate that includes a silicon film or a silicon-containing conductive film and a mask on the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film, and (b) supplying, into the chamber, a processing gas that contains a bromine containing gas, a phosphorus fluoride gas, and an oxygen containing gas, and generating a plasma from the processing gas to etch the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application is a bypass continuation application of international application No. PCT/JP2023/042868 having an international filing date of Nov. 30, 2023 and designating the United States, the international application being based upon and claiming the benefit of priority from Japanese Patent Application No. 2022-192621, filed on Dec. 1, 2022, the entire contents of each are incorporated herein by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] Exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure relate to an etching method and a plasma processing apparatus.

BACKGROUND

[0003] Patent Document 1 discloses a technique of etching a silicon-containing film.

CITATION LIST

Patent Documents

[0004] Patent Document 1: US2016/0343580

SUMMARY

[0005] The present disclosure provides a technique of preventing shape abnormalities due to etching of a silicon film.

[0006] The etching method in one exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure includes: (a) providing, on a substrate support disposed in a chamber, a substrate that includes a silicon film or a silicon-containing conductive film and a mask on the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film, and (b) supplying, into the chamber, a processing gas that contains a bromine containing gas, a phosphorus fluoride gas, and an oxygen containing gas, and generating a plasma from the processing gas to etch the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film.

[0007] According to one exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, a technique of preventing shape abnormalities due to etching of the silicon film can be provided.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

[0008] FIG. 1 is a diagram illustrating an example of a configuration of a plasma processing system.

[0009] FIG. 2 illustrates an example of a configuration of a capacitively coupled plasma processing apparatus.

[0010] FIG. 3 is a flowchart illustrating an example of an etching method.

[0011] FIG. 4 is a diagram illustrating an example of a cross-sectional structure of a substrate.

[0012] FIG. 5 is a diagram illustrating an example of a cross-sectional structure of the substrate during processing of step ST2.

[0013] FIG. 6 is a diagram illustrating an amount of F radicals generated when a plasma is generated using various gases.

[0014] FIG. 7 is a diagram illustrating results of etching a silicon film when a PF₃ gas and an NF₃ gas are used as part of a processing gas.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0015] An embodiment of the present disclosure will be described below.

[0016] In one exemplary embodiment, an etching method is provided, which includes: (a) providing, on a substrate support disposed in a chamber, a substrate that includes a silicon film or a silicon-containing conductive film and a mask on the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film, and (b) supplying, into the chamber, a processing gas that contains a bromine containing gas, a phosphorus fluoride gas, and an oxygen containing gas, and generating a plasma from the processing gas to etch the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film.

[0017] In one exemplary embodiment, the silicon-containing conductive film is a film containing silicon and germanium or a metal.

[0018] In one exemplary embodiment, the mask includes at least one selected from the group consisting of a silicon-containing insulating film, a metal-containing film, and an organic film.

[0019] In one exemplary embodiment, in (b), a ratio of a flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas to a flow rate of the processing gas is changed.

[0020] In one exemplary embodiment, (b) includes (b1) etching the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film with a first plasma generated from a first processing gas that contains a phosphorus fluoride gas at a first flow ratio, and (b2) etching the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film with a second plasma generated from a second processing gas that does not contain a phosphorus fluoride gas or contains a phosphorus fluoride gas at a second flow ratio smaller than the first flow ratio.

[0021] In one exemplary embodiment, (b2) is performed after (b1).

[0022] In one exemplary embodiment, (b1) is performed after (b2).

[0023] In one exemplary embodiment, (b1) and (b2) are repeated a plurality of times.

[0024] In one exemplary embodiment, a flow rate of the bromine containing gas is larger than a flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas.

[0025] In one exemplary embodiment, a flow rate of the bromine containing gas is 10 vol % or more and 99 vol % or less of a flow rate of the processing gas.

[0026] In one exemplary embodiment, a flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas is 0.1 vol % or more and 50 vol % or less of a flow rate of the processing gas.

[0027] In one exemplary embodiment, a ratio of a flow rate of the bromine containing gas to a flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas is in a range of 1 to 999.

[0028] In one exemplary embodiment, the bromine containing gas is at least one of an HBr gas and a Br.sub.2 gas.

[0029] In one exemplary embodiment, the phosphorus fluoride gas is at least one of a PF.sub.3 gas and a PF.sub.5 gas.

[0030] In one exemplary embodiment, the oxygen containing gas is at least one selected from the group consisting of an O.sub.2 gas, a CO gas, and a CO.sub.2 gas.

[0031] In one exemplary embodiment, an etching method is provided, which includes: (a) providing, on a substrate support disposed in a chamber, a substrate that includes a silicon film or a silicon-containing conductive film and a mask on the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film, and (b) supplying, into the chamber, a processing gas containing a first gas that contains a first halogen, a second gas that contains a second halogen and phosphorus, and an oxygen containing gas, and generating a plasma from the processing gas to etch the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film.

[0032] In one exemplary embodiment, the silicon-containing conductive film is a film containing silicon and germanium or a metal.

[0033] In one exemplary embodiment, in (b), a ratio of a flow rate of the second gas to a flow rate of the processing gas is changed.

[0034] In one exemplary embodiment, the mask includes at least one selected from the group consisting of a silicon-containing insulating film, a metal-containing film, and an organic film.

[0035] In one exemplary embodiment, the mask contains at least one selected from the group consisting of silicon oxide, SiON, W, WSi, WSIN, WC, TiN, and TiO.

[0036] In one exemplary embodiment, the first gas is at least one selected from the group consisting of an HBr gas, a Br.sub.2 gas, and a Cl.sub.2 gas.

[0037] In one exemplary embodiment, the second gas is at least one selected from the group consisting of a PF.sub.3 gas, a PF.sub.5 gas, and a PCl.sub.3 gas.

[0038] In one exemplary embodiment, there is provided a plasma processing apparatus, which includes: a chamber, a substrate support disposed in the chamber, a plasma generator, and a controller, the controller executing (a) control to provide, on the substrate support, a substrate that includes a silicon film or a silicon-containing conductive film and a mask on the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film, and (b) control to supply, into the chamber, a processing gas that contains a bromine containing gas, a phosphorus fluoride gas, and an oxygen containing gas, and generate a plasma from the processing gas to etch the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film.

[0039] An embodiment of the present disclosure will be described below in detail with reference to the drawings. In the drawings, the same or similar elements have the same reference characters, and duplicated descriptions thereof will be omitted. Unless otherwise specified, the upward-downward positional relationship, the rightward/leftward positional relationship, and other positional relationship will be described based on the positional relationships shown in the drawings. The dimensional ratios in the drawings are not equal to actual ratios, and the actual ratios are not limited to the ratios shown in the drawings.

<Example of Plasma Processing System>

[0040] FIG. 1 is a diagram illustrating an example of a configuration of a plasma processing system. In one embodiment, the plasma processing system includes a plasma processing apparatus **1** and a controller **2**. The plasma processing system is an example of a substrate processing system, and the plasma processing apparatus **1** is an example of a substrate processing apparatus. The plasma processing apparatus **1** includes a plasma processing chamber **10**, a substrate support **11**, and a plasma generator **12**. The plasma processing chamber **10** has a plasma processing space. The plasma processing chamber **10** has at least one gas supply port via which at least one processing gas is supplied into the plasma processing space, and at least one gas exhaust port via which the gas is exhausted from the plasma processing space. The gas supply port is connected to a gas supply **20**, which will be described later, and the gas exhaust port is connected to an exhaust system **40**, which will be described later. The substrate support **11** is disposed in the plasma processing space and has a substrate support surface for supporting a substrate.

[0041] The plasma generator **12** is configured to generate plasma from at least one processing gas supplied into the plasma processing space. The plasma formed in the plasma processing space may be capacitively coupled plasma (CCP), inductively coupled plasma (ICP), electron-cyclotron-resonance plasma (ECR plasma), helicon wave plasma (HWP), surface wave plasma (SWP), or the like. Furthermore, various types of plasma generators, including an alternating current (AC) plasma generator and a direct current (DC) plasma generator, may be used. In one embodiment, an AC signal (AC power) used by the AC plasma generator has a frequency within a range from 100 kHz to 10 GHz. The AC signal therefore includes a radio frequency (RF) signal and a microwave signal. In one embodiment, the RF signal has a frequency within a range from 100 kHz to 150 MHz.

[0042] The controller **2** processes computer-executable instructions for instructing the plasma processing apparatus **1** to execute various steps described herein below. The controller **2** may be configured to control elements of the plasma processing apparatus **1** to execute the various steps described herein below. In one embodiment, part or all of the controller **2** may be in the plasma processing apparatus **1**. The controller **2** may include, for example, a computer **2a**. For example, the computer **2a** may include a processor (central processing unit (CPU)) **2a1**, a storage **2a2**, and a communication interface **2a3**. The processor **2a1** may be configured to read a program from the

storage **2a2** and perform various control operations by executing the read program. The program may be stored in advance in the storage **2a2**, or may be acquired via a medium when necessary. The acquired program is stored in the storage **2a2**, read from the storage **2a2** by the processor **2a1**, and executed thereby. The medium may be various storing media readable by the computer **2a**, or may be a communication line connected to the communication interface **2a3**. The storage **2a2** may include a random access memory (RAM), a read only memory (ROM), a hard disk drive (HDD), a solid state drive (SSD), or a combination thereof. The communication interface **2a3** may communicate with the plasma processing apparatus **1** via a communication line such as a local area network (LAN). The functionality of the elements disclosed herein may be implemented using circuitry or processing circuitry which includes general purpose processors, special purpose processors, integrated circuits, ASICs (“Application Specific Integrated Circuits”), FPGAs (“Field-Programmable Gate Arrays”), conventional circuitry and/or combinations thereof which are programmed, using one or more programs stored in one or more memories, or otherwise configured to perform the disclosed functionality. Processors and controllers are considered processing circuitry or circuitry as they include transistors and other circuitry therein. In the disclosure, the circuitry, units, or means are hardware that carry out or are programmed to perform the recited functionality. The hardware may be any hardware disclosed herein which is programmed or configured to carry out the recited functionality. There is a memory that stores a computer program which includes computer instructions. These computer instructions provide the logic and routines that enable the hardware (e.g., processing circuitry or circuitry) to perform the method disclosed herein. This computer program can be implemented in known formats as a computer-readable storage medium, a computer program product, a memory device, a record medium such as a CD-ROM or DVD, and/or the memory of a FPGA or ASIC.

[0043] Hereinafter, a configuration example of an inductively coupled plasma processing apparatus as an example of the plasma processing apparatus **1** will be described. FIG. **2** is a diagram illustrating the configuration example of the inductively coupled plasma processing apparatus. The inductively coupled plasma processing apparatus **1** includes the plasma processing chamber **10**, the gas supply **20**, a power source **30**, and the exhaust system **40**. The plasma processing chamber **10** includes a dielectric window **101**. Further, the plasma processing apparatus **1** includes the substrate support **11**, a gas introduction unit, and an antenna **14**. The substrate support **11** is disposed in the plasma processing chamber **10**. The antenna **14** is disposed on or above the plasma processing chamber **10** (that is, on or above the dielectric window **101**). The plasma processing chamber **10** has a plasma processing space **10s** defined by the dielectric window **101**, a sidewall **102** of the plasma processing chamber **10**, and the substrate support **11**. The plasma processing chamber **10** is grounded.

[0044] The substrate support **11** includes a main body **111** and a ring assembly **112**. The main body **111** has a central region **111a**, which supports a substrate W, and an annular region **111b**, which supports the ring assembly **112**. A wafer is an example of the substrate W. The annular region **111b** of the main body **111** surrounds the central region **111a** of the main body **111** in a plan view. The substrate W is disposed on the central region **111a** of the main body **111**, and the ring assembly **112** is disposed on the annular region **111b** of the main body **111** so as to surround the substrate W on the central region **111a** of the main body **111**. Accordingly, the central region **111a** is also called a substrate support surface that supports the substrate W, and the annular region **111b** is also called a ring support surface that supports the ring assembly **112**.

[0045] In one embodiment, the main body **111** includes a base **1110** and an electrostatic chuck **1111**. The base **1110** includes a conductive member. The conductive member of the base **1110** may function as a bias electrode. The electrostatic chuck **1111** is disposed on the base **1110**. The electrostatic chuck **1111** includes a ceramic member **1111a**, and an electrostatic electrode **1111b** disposed in the ceramic member **1111a**. The ceramic member **1111a** has the central region **111a**. In one embodiment, the ceramic member **1111a** also has the annular region **111b**. Another member

that surrounds the electrostatic chuck **1111**, such as an annular electrostatic chuck and an annular insulating member, may have the annular region **111b**. In this case, the ring assembly **112** may be disposed on the annular electrostatic chuck or the annular insulating member, or may be disposed on both the electrostatic chuck **1111** and the annular insulating member. Further, an RF or DC electrode may be disposed in the ceramic member **1111a**, and in this case, the RF or DC electrode functions as a bias electrode. Both the conductive member of the base **1110** and the RF or DC electrode may function as the two bias electrodes.

[0046] The ring assembly **112** includes one or more annular members. In one embodiment, the one or more annular members include one or more edge rings and at least one cover ring. The edge ring is made of an electrically conductive material or an insulating material, and the cover ring is made of an insulating material.

[0047] The substrate support **11** may further include a temperature control module configured to adjust a temperature of at least one of the electrostatic chuck **1111**, the ring assembly **112**, and the substrate **W** to a target temperature. The temperature control module may include a heater, a heat transfer medium, a flow path **1110a**, or a combination thereof. A heat transfer fluid, such as brine or gas, flows through the flow path **1110a**. In one embodiment, the flow path **1110a** is formed in the base **1110**, and one or more heaters are disposed in the ceramic member **1111a** of the electrostatic chuck **1111**. Further, the substrate support **11** may include a heat transfer gas supply configured to supply a heat transfer gas to a gap between a rear surface of the substrate **W** and the central region **111a**.

[0048] The gas introduction unit is configured to introduce at least one processing gas from the gas supply **20** into the plasma processing space **10s**. In one embodiment, the gas introduction unit includes a center gas injector (CGI) **13**. The center gas injector **13** is disposed above the substrate support **11** and attached to a center opening formed in the dielectric window **101**. The center gas injector **13** has at least one gas supply port **13a**, at least one gas flow path **13b**, and at least one gas introduction port **13c**. The processing gas supplied to the gas supply port **13a** passes through the gas flow path **13b** and is introduced into the plasma processing space **10s** from the gas introduction port **13c**. The gas introduction unit may include one or more side gas injectors (SGI) attached to one or more openings formed in the sidewall **102**, in addition to or instead of the center gas injector **13**.

[0049] The gas supply **20** may include at least one gas source **21** and at least one flow rate controller **22**. In one embodiment, the gas supply **20** is configured to supply at least one processing gas from the respective corresponding gas sources **21** to the gas introduction unit through the respective corresponding flow rate controllers **22**. Each flow rate controller **22** may include, for example, a mass flow controller or a pressure-controlled flow rate controller. Further, the gas supply **20** may include at least one flow rate modulation device that modulates or pulses a flow rate of at least one processing gas.

[0050] The power source **30** includes an RF power source **31** coupled to the plasma processing chamber **10** via at least one impedance matching circuit. The RF power source **31** is configured to supply at least one RF signal (RF power), such as a source RF signal and a bias RF signal, to at least one bias electrode and the antenna **14**. Accordingly, the plasma is formed from at least one processing gas supplied into the plasma processing space **10s**.

[0051] Accordingly, the RF power source **31** may function as at least a part of the plasma generator **12**. Supplying the bias RF signal to at least one bias electrode can generate a bias potential in the substrate **W** to attract ions in the formed plasma to the substrate **W**.

[0052] In one embodiment, the RF power source **31** includes a first RF generator **31a** and a second RF generator **31b**. The first RF generator **31a** is configured to be coupled to the antenna **14** through at least one impedance matching circuit so as to generate the source RF signal (source RF power) for plasma generation. In one embodiment, the source RF signal has a frequency within a range from 10 MHz to 150 MHz. In one embodiment, the first RF generator **31a** may be configured to

generate a plurality of source RF signals having different frequencies. The generated one or more source RF signals are supplied to the antenna **14**.

[0053] The second RF generator **31b** is coupled to at least one bias electrode via the at least one impedance matching circuit and configured to generate the bias RF signal (bias RF power). A frequency of the bias RF signal may be the same as or different from a frequency of the source RF signal. In one embodiment, the bias RF signal has a frequency lower than the frequency of the source RF signal. In one embodiment, the bias RF signal has a frequency within a range from 100 kHz to 60 MHz. In one embodiment, the second RF generator **31b** may be configured to generate a plurality of bias RF signals having different frequencies. The generated one or more bias RF signals are supplied to at least one bias electrode. In various embodiments, at least one of the source RF signal and the bias RF signal may be pulsed.

[0054] The power source **30** may include a DC power source **32** coupled to the plasma processing chamber **10**. The DC power source **32** includes a bias DC generator **32a**. In one embodiment, the bias DC generator **32a** is connected to at least one bias electrode and configured to generate a bias DC signal. The generated bias DC signal is applied to at least one bias electrode.

[0055] In various embodiments, the bias DC signal may be pulsed. In this case, a sequence of DC-based voltage pulses is applied to at least one bias electrode. The voltage pulses may each have a rectangular, trapezoidal, or triangular pulse waveform or a combination thereof. In one embodiment, a waveform generator for generating the sequence of voltage pulses from the DC signal is connected between the bias DC generator **32a** and at least one bias electrode. Accordingly, the bias DC generator **32a** and the waveform generator configure a voltage pulse generator. The voltage pulse may have a positive polarity or a negative polarity. Further, the sequence of the voltage pulses may include one or more positive voltage pulses and one or more negative voltage pulses in one cycle. The bias DC generator **32a** may be provided in addition to the RF power source **31**, or may be provided instead of the second RF generator **31b**.

[0056] The antenna **14** includes one or more coils. In one embodiment, the antenna **14** may include an outer coil and an inner coil that are coaxially disposed. In this case, the RF power source **31** may be connected to both the outer coil and the inner coil, or may be connected to any one of the outer coil and the inner coil. In the former case, the same RF generator may be connected to both the outer coil and the inner coil, or separate RF generators may be connected to the outer coil and the inner coil, respectively.

[0057] The exhaust system **40** may be connected, for example, to a gas exhaust port **10e** disposed at a bottom of the plasma processing chamber **10**. The exhaust system **40** may include a pressure adjusting valve and a vacuum pump. The pressure adjusting valve adjusts a pressure in the plasma processing space **10s**. The vacuum pump may include a turbo molecular pump, a dry pump, or a combination thereof.

Examples of Etching Method

[0058] FIG. **3** is a flowchart illustrating an etching method (hereinafter, also referred to as a “present processing method”) according to one exemplary embodiment. As shown in FIG. **3**, in one embodiment, the present processing method includes step ST1 of providing a substrate, and step ST2 of performing etching. Processing in each of the steps may be executed by the plasma processing system illustrated in FIG. **2**. Hereinafter, a case where the controller **2** controls each part of the plasma processing apparatus **1** to execute the present processing method for the substrate W will be described by way of an example.

Step ST1: Provision of Substrate

[0059] In step ST1, the substrate W is provided into the plasma processing space **10s** of the plasma processing apparatus **1**. In one embodiment, the substrate W is provided in the central region **111a** of the substrate support **11**. Then, the substrate W is held by the substrate support **11** by the electrostatic chuck **111**.

[0060] FIG. **4** is a diagram illustrating an example of a cross-sectional structure of the substrate W.

In the substrate W, a silicon film SiF and a mask MF are stacked in this order on or above an underlying film UF. The substrate W may be used for manufacturing a semiconductor device. The semiconductor device includes, for example, a semiconductor memory device such as a DRAM or a 3D-NAND flash memory and a logic device.

[0061] The underlying film UF is, in an example, a silicon wafer, or an organic film, a dielectric film, a metal-containing film, a semiconductor film, or the like formed on the silicon wafer. The underlying film UF may be configured by stacking a plurality of films.

[0062] The silicon film SiF is a film that is an etching target in the present processing method. The silicon film SiF may be any of a polycrystalline silicon film, a single crystal silicon film, and an amorphous silicon film. The silicon film SiF may contain impurities such as phosphorus, boron, and nitrogen.

[0063] The mask MF is a film that functions as a mask in the etching of the silicon film SiF. The mask MF may be a film different from an etching target film. The mask MF may be at least one selected from the group consisting of a silicon-containing insulating film, a metal-containing film, and an organic film. The silicon-containing insulating film may be a silicon oxide film, a silicon nitride film, or a silicon oxynitride (SiON) film. The metal-containing film may be a film containing tungsten (W), titanium (Ti), or ruthenium (Ru). The mask MF may contain at least one selected from the group consisting of tungsten (W), tungsten silicide (WSi), tungsten silicide nitride (WSiN), tungsten carbide (WC), tungsten silicide carbide (WSiC), titanium nitride (TiN), titanium oxide (TiO), ruthenium (Ru), ruthenium carbide (RuC), ruthenium nitride (RuN), and ruthenium silicide (RuSi). The organic film may be an amorphous carbon film or a spin-on carbon film. In one embodiment, the mask MF contains at least one selected from the group consisting of silicon oxide, SiON, W, WSi, WSIN, WC, TiN, and TiO.

[0064] As illustrated in FIG. 4, the mask MF defines at least one opening OP on the silicon film SiF. The opening OP is a space on the silicon film SiF and is surrounded by a sidewall of the mask MF. That is, an upper surface of the silicon film SiF has a region covered with the mask MF and a region exposed at a bottom of the opening OP.

[0065] The opening OP may have any shape in a plan view of the substrate W, that is, when the substrate W is viewed in a downward direction from above in FIG. 4. The shape may be, for example, a circle, an ellipse, a rectangle, a line, or a shape obtained by combining one or more types thereof. The mask MF may have a plurality of sidewalls, and the plurality of sidewalls may define a plurality of openings OP. The plurality of openings OP may each have a linear shape, and may be arranged at regular intervals to form a line and space pattern. Further, the plurality of openings OP may each have a hole shape and may form an array pattern.

[0066] Each of the films (the underlying film UF, the silicon film SiF, and the mask MF) constituting the substrate W may be formed by a CVD method, an ALD method, a spin coating method, or the like. The opening OP may be formed by etching the mask MF. Further, the mask MF may be formed by lithography. Each of the above-described films may be a flat film or a film having unevenness. The substrate W may further have another film below the underlying film UF, and a stacked film containing the silicon film SiF and the underlying film UF may function as a multilayer mask. That is, the other film may be etched using the stacked film of the silicon film SiF and the underlying film UF as the multilayer mask.

[0067] At least a part of processes of forming the films of the substrate W may be performed in a space of the plasma processing chamber 10 illustrated in FIG. 2. In an example, a step of etching the mask MF to form the opening OP may be executed in the plasma processing chamber 10. That is, the etching of the opening OP and the silicon film SiF, which will be described later, may be consecutively executed in the same chamber. Further, the substrate may be provided by forming all or some of the respective films of the substrate W with an apparatus or a chamber outside the plasma processing apparatus 1, and then carrying the substrate W into the plasma processing space 10s of the plasma processing apparatus 1 and disposing the substrate W on the central region 111a

of the substrate support **11**.

[0068] In one embodiment, after the substrate W is provided in the central region **111a** of the substrate support **11**, a temperature of the substrate support **11** is adjusted to a set temperature by the temperature control module. The temperature of the substrate support **11** is set to, for example, a range of 10° C. or higher and 120° C. or lower. In an example, adjusting or maintaining the temperature of the substrate support **11** includes adjusting or maintaining the temperature of the heat transfer fluid flowing through the flow path **1110a** to the set temperature or a temperature different from the set temperature. In an example, adjusting or maintaining the temperature of the substrate support **11** includes controlling the pressure of a heat transfer gas (for example, He) between the electrostatic chuck **1111** and the rear surface of the substrate W. The time at which the heat transfer fluid starts to flow through the flow path **1110a** may be before or after the substrate W is placed on the substrate support **11**, or may be at the same time. Further, in the present processing method, the temperature of the substrate support **11** may be adjusted to the set temperature before step ST1. That is, after the temperature of the substrate support **11** is adjusted to the set temperature, the substrate W may be provided to the substrate support **11**. In steps subsequent to step ST1, the temperature of the substrate support **11** may be maintained at the set temperature adjusted in step ST1. The temperature of the substrate W on the substrate support **11** may be adjusted to, for example, a range of 10° C. or higher and 250° C. or lower. The adjustment or maintenance of the temperature of the substrate W may be performed by adjusting the temperature of the substrate support **11** described above.

(Step ST2: Etching)

[0069] In step ST2, first, a processing gas is supplied from the gas supply **20** into the plasma processing space **10s**. The processing gas may contain a bromine containing gas, a phosphorus fluoride gas, and an oxygen containing gas. A flow rate of the bromine containing gas may be the largest with respect to a total flow rate of the processing gas. Flow rates of the bromine containing gas, the phosphorus fluoride gas, and the oxygen containing gas may be 30 vol % or more, 50 vol % or more, 60 vol % or more, and 70 vol % or more with respect to the total flow rate of the processing gas. The processing gas may be free of a fluorine containing gas other than phosphorus fluoride. The processing gas may not contain a hydrogen fluoride gas, may not contain a fluorocarbon gas, or may not contain a hydrofluorocarbon gas.

[0070] The flow rate of the bromine containing gas may be larger than the flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas. The flow rate of the bromine containing gas may be 10 vol % or more and 99 vol % or less of the flow rate of the processing gas (when the processing gas contains another gas such as an inert gas, the flow rate excluding the other gas). The flow rate of the bromine containing gas may be 30 vol % or more or 50 vol % or more of the flow rate of the processing gas. The flow rate of the bromine containing gas may be 95 vol % or less or 90 vol % or less of the flow rate of the processing gas. The flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas may be 0.1 vol % or more and 50 vol % or less of the flow rate of the processing gas. The flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas may be 1 vol % or more, 2 vol % or more, or 3 vol % or more of the flow rate of the processing gas. The flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas may be 30 vol % or less, 20 vol % or less, 10 vol % or less, or 5 vol % or less of the flow rate of the processing gas. A ratio of the flow rate of the bromine containing gas to the flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas (the flow rate of the bromine containing gas/the flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas) may be in a range of 1 to 999.

[0071] The bromine containing gas may be at least one of an HBr gas, a Br.sub.2 gas, a CBr.sub.2F.sub.2 gas, and an S.sub.2Br.sub.2 gas, and may be at least one of an HBr gas and a Br.sub.2 gas.

[0072] The phosphorus fluoride gas is a gas containing fluorine and phosphorus, and in one example, may be at least one selected from the group consisting of a PF.sub.3 gas, a PF.sub.5 gas, a POF.sub.3 gas, an HPF.sub.2 gas, an H.sub.2PF.sub.3 gas, and an HPF gas. In one example, the phosphorus fluoride gas may be at least one gas of the PF.sub.3 gas and the PF.sub.5 gas.

[0073] The oxygen containing gas may be, for example, at least one selected from the group consisting of an O.sub.2 gas, a CO gas, a CO.sub.2 gas, an H.sub.2O gas, and an H.sub.2O.sub.2 gas. In one example, the oxygen containing gas may be an oxygen containing gas other than the H.sub.2O gas and the H.sub.2O.sub.2 gas, for example, may be at least one selected from the group consisting of the O.sub.2 gas, the CO gas, and the CO.sub.2 gas.

[0074] The processing gas may further contain an inert gas. The inert gas may be, in one example, a rare gas such as an Ar gas, a He gas, or a Kr gas, or a nitrogen gas.

[0075] The processing gas may contain a gas containing another halogen different from bromine, instead of or in addition to the bromine containing gas. In one example, the processing gas may include a Cl.sub.2 gas.

[0076] The processing gas may contain a gas containing phosphorus and another halogen different from fluorine, instead of or in addition to the phosphorus fluoride gas. In one example, the processing gas may contain a PCl.sub.3 gas.

[0077] In step ST2, next, a plasma is generated from the processing gas, and the silicon film SiF is etched using the plasma. First, the source RF signal is supplied to the antenna **14**. In this way, a radio-frequency electric field is generated between the antenna **14** and the substrate support **11**, so that plasma is generated from the processing gas in the plasma processing space **10s**. At this time, the bias signal may be supplied to the bias electrode of the substrate support **11**. In this case, a bias potential is generated between the plasma and the substrate W. Active species such as ions and radicals in the plasma are attracted to the substrate W, and the silicon film SiF is etched by the active species. The bias signal may be a bias RF signal supplied from the RF power source **31** or a bias DC signal supplied from the DC power source **32**.

[0078] FIG. **5** is a diagram illustrating an example of a cross-sectional structure of the substrate W during processing of step ST2. As shown in FIG. **5**, a portion of the silicon film SiF exposed in the opening OP is etched in a depth direction (a downward direction from above in FIG. **5**) by the processing in step ST2, so that a recess RC is formed. A protective film PF is formed on a sidewall of the recess RC and a surface of the mask MF.

[0079] In the present processing method, the processing gas contains at least a bromine containing gas, a phosphorus fluoride gas, and an oxygen containing gas. The active species generated from the bromine containing gas mainly function as an etchant for removing the silicon film SiF. The active species generated from the oxygen containing gas have a function of adjusting an amount of by-products (the protective film PF) that are deposited on the sidewall of the recess RC and the surface of the mask MF. The active species generated from the phosphorus fluoride gas have a function of reducing by-products (the protective film PF) that are deposited near the opening OP of the mask MF.

[0080] In one example, bromine ions (Br.sup.+) derived from the bromine containing gas and oxygen radicals (O*) derived from the oxygen containing gas form the protective film PF containing a silicon-based by-product (SiBrO) on the sidewall of the recess RC and the surface of the mask MF. In one example, phosphorus fluoride ions (PF_x.sup.+) derived from the phosphorus fluoride gas remove by-products (excessive protective film PF) that are deposited near the opening OP of the mask MF. Accordingly, it is possible to prevent a vicinity of the opening OP of the mask MF from being blocked or narrowed. Since the phosphorus fluoride gas is less likely to dissociate and an amount of the F radicals (F*) is small, scraping (bowing) of the sidewall of the recess RC is prevented. In one example, the phosphorus fluoride ions (PF_x.sup.+) derived from the phosphorus fluoride gas remove the protective film PF formed at a bottom of the recess RC. Accordingly, the silicon film SiF at the bottom of the recess RC is exposed, and the etching of the silicon film SiF in the depth direction is promoted by the bromine ions (Br.sup.+). In an example, by-products are deposited on the sidewall of the recess RC by a phosphorus component such as a phosphorus fluoride radical (PF_x*) derived from the phosphorus fluoride gas. Accordingly, the sidewall of the recess RC is prevented from being scraped (bowing), and etching selectivity is improved.

[0081] According to the present exemplary embodiment, the etching method includes: step (ST1) of providing the substrate W that includes the silicon film SiF and the mask MF on the silicon film SiF on the substrate support **11** in the chamber **10**, and the mask MF includes the silicon oxide, and the step (ST2) of supplying the processing gas that contains a bromine containing gas, a phosphorus fluoride gas, and an oxygen containing gas into the chamber **10**, and generating a plasma from the processing gas to etch the silicon film SiF. Accordingly, since the vicinity of the opening OP of the mask MF is prevented from narrowing and the sidewall of the recess RC of the silicon film SiF is prevented from being scraped, shape abnormalities due to etching of the silicon film SiF can be prevented.

Examples

[0082] FIG. **6** is a diagram illustrating an amount of F radicals generated when a plasma is generated using various gases. In an experiment, the plasma was generated using a processing gas that contained an SF.sub.6 gas, an NF.sub.3 gas, a CF.sub.4 gas, or a PF.sub.3 gas, and the amount of F radicals generated was measured by an optical emission spectrometer. As shown in FIG. **6**, when the PF.sub.3 gas was used, the amount of F radicals generated was small. Ionization energy of the PF.sub.3 gas is lower than ionization energy of the NF.sub.3 gas, and the PF.sub.3 gas is easily ionized. Therefore, it can be seen that in the plasma generated from the processing gas that contains the PF.sub.3 gas, the amount of F radicals is smaller, and an amount of phosphorus fluoride ions is larger, resulting in a smaller ratio of radicals/ions, than that in the plasma generated from the processing gas that contains the NF.sub.3 gas. Due to the small amount of F radicals, the excessive protective film PF near the opening OP is removed, while the protective film PF on the sidewall of the recess RC located deeper than the opening OP is prevented from being scraped. Due to the large amount of the phosphorus fluoride ions, the phosphorus fluoride ions etch the protective film PF formed at the bottom of the recess RC to expose the silicon film SiF, so that the bromine ions can reach the silicon film SiF. Accordingly, it is possible to promote the etching of the silicon film SiF in the depth direction.

[0083] FIG. **7** illustrates results of etching the silicon film SiF when the PF.sub.3 gas and the NF.sub.3 gas are used as a part of the processing gas. FIG. **7** is a diagram schematically illustrating an image obtained by capturing an image of the etched silicon film SiF by a scanning electron microscope. The etching was performed at a set temperature of the substrate support of 60° C., and the flow rates of the various gases were set to flow ratios shown in Table 1.

TABLE-US-00001 TABLE 1 When PF.sub.3 is used When NF.sub.3 is used HBr (vol %) 80.6 74.0 O.sub.2 (vol %) 3.0 2.7 Ar (vol %) 14.9 13.7 PF.sub.3 (vol %) 1.5 0 NF.sub.3 (vol %) 0 9.6 HBr/PF.sub.3 54 0

[0084] When the PF.sub.3 gas was used, there was no deposit near the opening OP of the mask MF that blocks the opening. As a result of measuring dimensions of line widths at an upper portion, a middle portion, and a lower portion of the silicon film SiF for each of the cases where the NF.sub.3 gas and the PF.sub.3 gas were used, it was confirmed that when the PF.sub.3 gas was used, there was less deviation in the dimensions of the line width of the silicon film SiF than when the NF.sub.3 gas was used, and the shape abnormalities were prevented. As a result of calculating an etching rate (ER) for each of the cases where the NF.sub.3 gas and the PF.sub.3 gas were used, it was confirmed that the etching rate was improved when the PF.sub.3 gas was used compared with when the NF.sub.3 gas was used. As a result of measuring a depth of a hole in the silicon film SiF and a thickness of the mask for each of the cases where the NF.sub.3 gas and the PF.sub.3 gas were used, it was confirmed that etching selectivity was improved when the PF.sub.3 gas was used than when the NF.sub.3 gas was used.

[0085] In the embodiment described above, in the etching step ST2, a ratio of the flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas to the flow rate of the processing gas may be changed. In one embodiment, the ratio (Ra) of the flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas to the flow rate of the processing gas may be changed according to a depth of the recess RC of the silicon film SiF. In one embodiment,

the ratio (Ra) of the flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas may be increased as the recess RC of the silicon film SiF becomes deeper. The ratio (Ra) of the flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas may be reduced as the recess RC of the silicon film SiF becomes deeper. In one embodiment, the etching step ST2 may include a first etching step ST21 and a second etching step ST22. The first etching step ST21 is a step of etching the silicon film SiF with a first plasma generated from a first processing gas that contains the phosphorus fluoride gas at a first flow ratio. The second etching step ST22 is a step of etching the silicon film SiF with a second plasma generated from a second processing gas that does not contain the phosphorus fluoride gas or contains the phosphorus fluoride gas at a second flow ratio smaller than the first flow ratio. The second etching step ST22 may be performed after the first etching step ST21, the first etching step ST21 may be performed after the second etching step ST22, and the first etching step ST21 and the second etching step ST22 may be repeated a plurality of times. The first processing gas may be the processing gas described in the above embodiment, which contains the bromine containing gas, the phosphorus fluoride gas, and the oxygen containing gas. The second processing gas may be the processing gas that contains the bromine containing gas, the phosphorus fluoride gas, and the oxygen containing gas described in the above embodiment, or may be the processing gas that contains the bromine containing gas and the oxygen containing gas and does not contain phosphorus fluoride.

[0086] In the embodiment described above, the etching step ST2 may include a first period in which the phosphorus fluoride gas is not supplied, and a second period in which the phosphorus fluoride gas is supplied. In one embodiment, in the first period of the etching step ST2, the plasma may be generated from the processing gas that contains the bromine containing gas and the oxygen containing gas to etch the silicon film SiF, and thereafter, in the second period, the plasma may be generated from the processing gas that contains the bromine containing gas, the oxygen containing gas, and the phosphorus fluoride gas to etch the silicon film SiF. The first period and the second period may be alternately repeated.

[0087] In the embodiment described above, the etching target film is a silicon film. However, the etching target film may be a silicon-containing conductive film. The silicon-containing conductive film may be a film containing silicon and germanium, or a film containing silicon and a metal. That is, the silicon-containing conductive film may be SiGe or a metal silicide such as WSi.

[0088] In the embodiment described above, the present processing method is not limited to be performed by the inductively coupled plasma processing apparatus, and may be performed by another type of plasma processing apparatus, for example, a plasma processing apparatus that generates a capacitively coupled plasma, a plasma processing apparatus that generates an ECR plasma, a plasma processing apparatus that generates a helicon wave plasma, or a plasma processing apparatus that generates a surface wave plasma.

[0089] The present disclosure may include, for example, following configurations.

Appendix 1

[0090] An etching method including: [0091] (a) providing, on a substrate support disposed in a chamber, a substrate that includes a silicon film or a silicon-containing conductive film and a mask on the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film, and [0092] (b) supplying, into the chamber, a processing gas that contains a bromine containing gas, a phosphorus fluoride gas, and an oxygen containing gas, and generating a plasma from the processing gas to etch the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film.

Appendix 2

[0093] The etching method according to Appendix 1, in which the silicon-containing conductive film is a film containing silicon and germanium or a metal.

Appendix 3

[0094] The etching method according to Appendix 1 or 2, in which the mask includes at least one selected from the group consisting of a silicon-containing insulating film, a metal-containing film, and an organic film.

Appendix 4

[0095] The etching method according to any one of Appendixes 1 to 3, in which in (b), a ratio of a flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas to a flow rate of the processing gas is changed.

Appendix 5

[0096] The etching method according to any one of Appendixes 1 to 4, in which [0097] (b) includes [0098] (b1) etching the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film with a first plasma generated from a first processing gas that contains a phosphorus fluoride gas at a first flow ratio, and [0099] (b2) etching the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film with a second plasma generated from a second processing gas that does not contain a phosphorus fluoride gas or contains a phosphorus fluoride gas at a second flow ratio smaller than the first flow ratio.

Appendix 6

[0100] The etching method according to Appendix 5, in which [0101] (b2) is performed after (b1).

Appendix 7

[0102] The etching method according to Appendix 5, in which [0103] (b1) is performed after (b2).

Appendix 8

[0104] The etching method according to any one of Appendixes 5 to 7, in which [0105] (b1) and (b2) are repeated a plurality of times.

Appendix 9

[0106] The etching method according to any one of Appendixes 1 to 8, in which [0107] a flow rate of the bromine containing gas is larger than a flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas.

Appendix 10

[0108] The etching method according to any one of Appendixes 1 to 9, in which [0109] a flow rate of the bromine containing gas is 10 vol % or more and 99 vol % or less of a flow rate of the processing gas.

Appendix 11

[0110] The etching method according to any one of Appendixes 1 to 10, in which [0111] a flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas is 0.1 vol % or more and 50 vol % or less of a flow rate of the processing gas.

Appendix 12

[0112] The etching method according to any one of Appendixes 1 to 11, in which [0113] a ratio of a flow rate of the bromine containing gas to a flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas is in a range of 1 to 999.

Appendix 13

[0114] The etching method according to any one of Appendixes 1 to 12, in which [0115] the bromine containing gas is at least one of an HBr gas and a Br.sub.2 gas.

Appendix 14

[0116] The etching method according to any one of Appendixes 1 to 13, in which [0117] the phosphorus fluoride gas is at least one of a PF.sub.3 gas and a PF.sub.5 gas.

Appendix 15

[0118] The etching method according to any one of Appendixes 1 to 14, in which [0119] the oxygen containing gas is at least one selected from the group consisting of an O.sub.2 gas, a CO gas, and a CO.sub.2 gas.

Appendix 16

[0120] An etching method including: [0121] (a) providing, on a substrate support disposed in a chamber, a substrate that includes a silicon film or a silicon-containing conductive film and a mask on the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film, and [0122] (b) supplying, into the chamber, a processing gas containing a first gas that contains a first halogen, a second gas that contains a second halogen and phosphorus, and an oxygen containing gas, and generating a plasma from the processing gas to etch the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film.

Appendix 17

[0123] The etching method according to Appendix 16, in which [0124] the silicon-containing conductive film is a film containing silicon and germanium or a metal.

Appendix 18

[0125] The etching method according to Appendix 16 or 17, in which [0126] in (b), a ratio of a flow rate of the second gas to a flow rate of the processing gas is changed.

Appendix 19

[0127] The etching method according to any one of Appendixes 16 to 18, in which [0128] the mask includes at least one selected from the group consisting of a silicon-containing insulating film, a metal-containing film, and an organic film.

Appendix 20

[0129] The etching method according to any one of Appendixes 16 to 19, in which [0130] the mask contains at least one selected from the group consisting of silicon oxide, SiON, W, WSi, WSIN, WC, TiN, and TiO.

Appendix 21

[0131] The etching method according to any one of Appendixes 16 to 20, in which [0132] the first gas is at least one selected from the group consisting of an HBr gas, a Br.sub.2 gas, and a Cl.sub.2 gas.

Appendix 22

[0133] The etching method according to any one of Appendixes 16 to 21, in which [0134] the second gas is at least one selected from the group consisting of a PF.sub.3 gas, a PF.sub.5 gas, and a PCl.sub.3 gas.

Appendix 23

[0135] A plasma processing apparatus including: [0136] a chamber, [0137] a substrate support disposed in the chamber, [0138] a plasma generator, and [0139] a controller, the controller executing (a) control to provide, on the substrate support, a substrate that includes a silicon film or a silicon-containing conductive film and a mask on the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film, and (b) control to supply, into the chamber, a processing gas that contains a bromine containing gas, a phosphorus fluoride gas, and an oxygen containing gas, and generate a plasma from the processing gas to etch the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film. [0140] In the exemplary embodiments described above, the plasma processing apparatus and the plasma processing method may be modified without departing from the scope and spirit of the present disclosure. For example, some components in an embodiment may be added to another embodiment within the ordinary creative range of a person skilled in the art. Some elements in an embodiment may be replaced with corresponding elements in another embodiment.

Claims

1. An etching method comprising: (a) providing, on a substrate support disposed in a chamber, a substrate that includes: a silicon film or a silicon-containing conductive film; and a mask on the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film, and (b) supplying, into the chamber, a processing gas that contains a bromine containing gas, a phosphorus fluoride gas, and an oxygen containing gas, and generating a plasma from the processing gas to etch the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film.
2. The etching method according to claim 1, wherein the silicon-containing conductive film is a film containing silicon and germanium or a metal.
3. The etching method according to claim 1, wherein the mask includes at least one selected from the group consisting of a silicon-containing insulating film, a metal-containing film, and an organic film.
4. The etching method according to claim 1, wherein in (b), a ratio of a flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas to a flow rate of the processing gas is changed.

5. The etching method according to claim 1, wherein (b) includes (b1) etching the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film with a first plasma generated from a first processing gas that contains the phosphorus fluoride gas at a first flow ratio, and (b2) etching the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film with a second plasma generated from a second processing gas that does not contain a phosphorus fluoride gas or contains a phosphorus fluoride gas at a second flow ratio smaller than the first flow ratio.
6. The etching method according to claim 5, wherein (b2) is performed after (b1).
7. The etching method according to claim 5, wherein (b1) is performed after (b2).
8. The etching method according to claim 5, wherein (b1) and (b2) are repeated a plurality of times.
9. The etching method according to claim 1, wherein a flow rate of the bromine containing gas is larger than a flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas.
10. The etching method according to claim 1, wherein a flow rate of the bromine containing gas is 10 vol % or more and 99 vol % or less of a flow rate of the processing gas.
11. The etching method according to claim 1, wherein a flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas is 0.1 vol % or more and 50 vol % or less of a flow rate of the processing gas.
12. The etching method according to claim 1, wherein a ratio of a flow rate of the bromine containing gas to a flow rate of the phosphorus fluoride gas is in a range of 1 to 999.
13. The etching method according to claim 1, wherein the bromine containing gas is at least one of an HBr gas and a Br.sub.2 gas.
14. The etching method according to claim 1, wherein the phosphorus fluoride gas is at least one of a PF.sub.3 gas and a PF.sub.5 gas.
15. The etching method according to claim 1, wherein the oxygen containing gas is at least one selected from the group consisting of an O.sub.2 gas, a CO gas, and a CO.sub.2 gas.
16. An etching method comprising: (a) providing, on a substrate support disposed in a chamber, a substrate that includes: a silicon film or a silicon-containing conductive film; and a mask on the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film, and (b) supplying, into the chamber, a processing gas containing a first gas that contains a first halogen, a second gas that contains a second halogen and phosphorus, and an oxygen containing gas, and generating a plasma from the processing gas to etch the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film.
17. The etching method according to claim 16, wherein the silicon-containing conductive film is a film containing silicon and germanium or a metal.
18. The etching method according to claim 16, wherein in (b), a ratio of a flow rate of the second gas to a flow rate of the processing gas is changed.
19. The etching method according to claim 16, wherein the mask includes at least one selected from the group consisting of a silicon-containing insulating film, a metal-containing film, and an organic film.
20. The etching method according to claim 16, wherein the mask contains at least one selected from the group consisting of silicon oxide, SiON, W, WSi, WSIN, WC, TiN, and TiO.
21. The etching method according to claim 16, wherein the first gas is at least one selected from the group consisting of an HBr gas, a Br.sub.2 gas, and a Cl.sub.2 gas.
22. The etching method according to claim 16, wherein the second gas is at least one selected from the group consisting of a PF.sub.3 gas, a PF.sub.5 gas, and a PCl.sub.3 gas.
23. A plasma processing apparatus comprising: a chamber, a substrate support disposed in the chamber, a plasma generator, and a controller having a processor and a memory with a computer readable program stored therein that upon execution of the computer readable program by the processor configures the controller to execute: (a) control to provide, on the substrate support, a substrate that includes: a silicon film or a silicon-containing conductive film; and a mask on the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film, and (b) control to supply, into the chamber, a processing gas that contains a bromine containing gas, a phosphorus fluoride gas, and an oxygen

containing gas, and generate a plasma from the processing gas to etch the silicon film or the silicon-containing conductive film.
